

Follow the Instructions. Build the Lego.

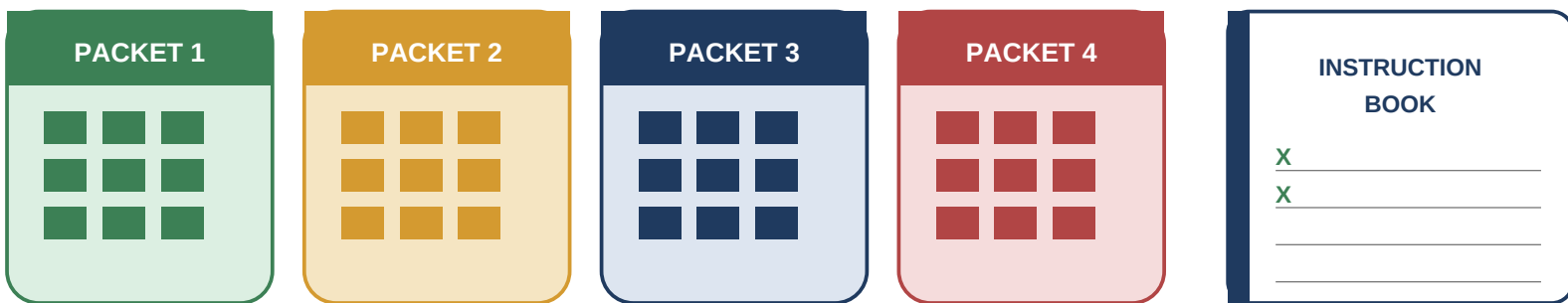
The Lego-set principle. Pick. Pack. Cross off. Build. The system that produces the jet hopper every time — and the trap that turns it into a pile of bricks.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 The pick-and-pack system**
Four tubs. One book. Cross off as you go.
- 02 Creativity vs instructions**
Two different jobs. Don't mix them up.
- 03 The drift sequence**
Where the build goes wrong — and when.
- 04 The blame loop**
What it sounds like vs what's really happening.
- 05 The two-week test**
Settle the question once. Run the experiment.
- 06 Daily reference card**
Print and pin. Read before every pitch.

The pick-and-pack system.

Four tubs on the table. One instruction book. Cross off each step. The system the jet hopper actually requires.



THE GUARANTEE

Follow this exactly and the odds of finishing the build are roughly 99.9%. The system is what produces the outcome. The free-style is what destroys it.

Creativity time + instruction time.

Both are valuable. They are two different jobs. The trouble starts when reps confuse the two.

CREATIVITY TIME

Open-ended. No right answer. Permission to experiment is the whole point.

WHEN IT APPLIES:

- Brainstorming new offers.
- Designing the next product.
- Naming a campaign.
- Writing fresh copy.
- Strategy off-sites.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE:

"What ideas have you got?" "How would you approach this?" "What's missing from this offer?"

INSTRUCTION TIME

Closed. The right answer is the pattern that has worked before. Free-styling here costs deals.

WHEN IT APPLIES:

- Pitching a client.
- Closing a deal.
- Running the playbook.
- Delivering a script.
- Following the close sequence.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE:

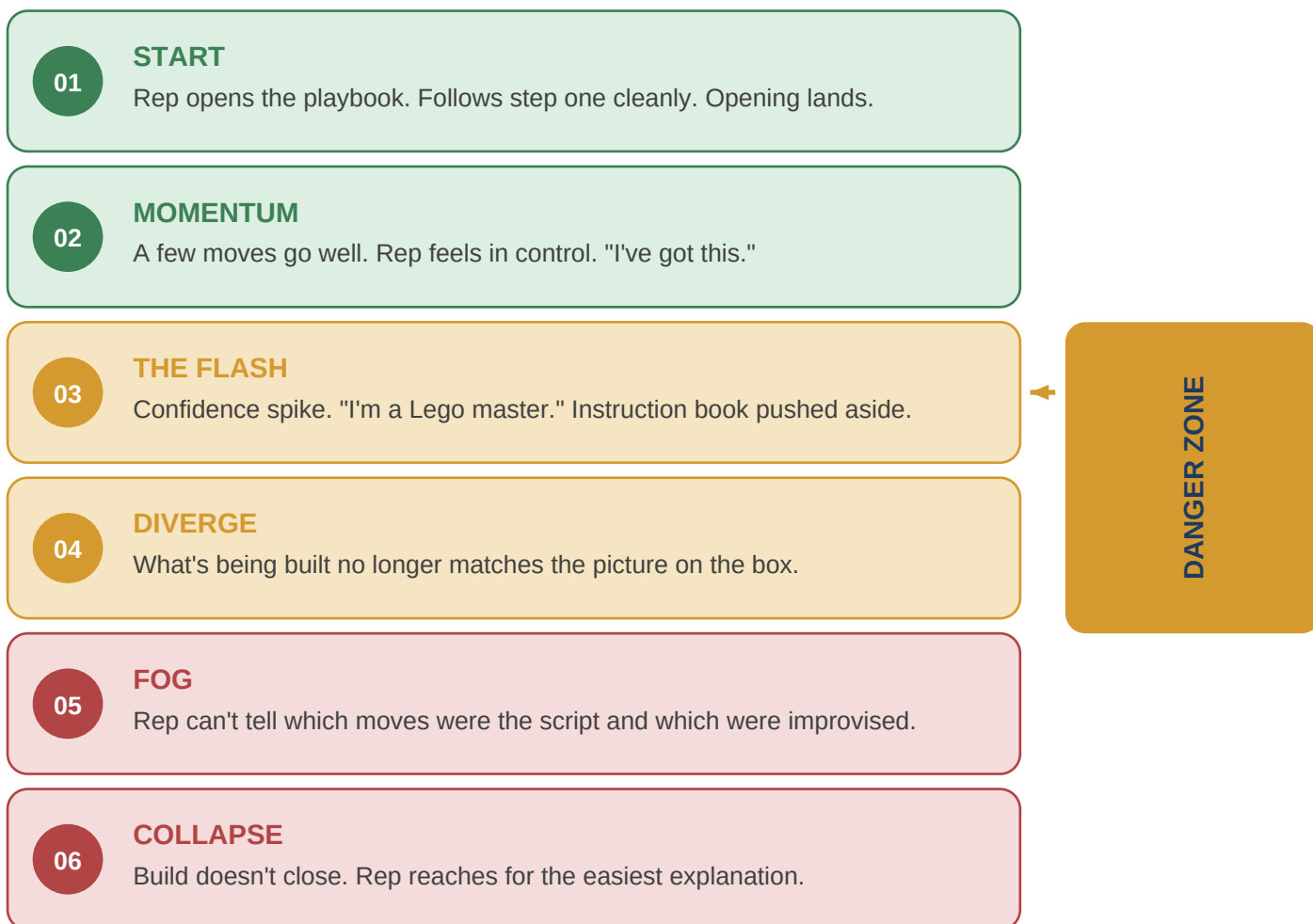
"Follow step one. Then step two." "Do exactly what the script says, then close."

THE TEST BEFORE YOU ACT

Before any pitch, ask: is the instruction book open right now? If yes, free-styling has been revoked. Build the thing.

The drift sequence.

Reps almost always start by following the instructions. The drift happens about a third of the way through.



WHERE TO INTERVENE

The drift point isn't the start of the pitch. It's the third-of-the-way-in confidence flash. Train yourself to catch it there — not when the build is already collapsing.

The blame loop.

When the build collapses, two stories compete inside the rep's head. Only one is true.

WHAT THE REP SAYS

"The instructions were bad. The playbook is wrong. The coach is too harsh. The leads were no good. The market is off."

WHAT IT PROTECTS:

- Ego — "I would've closed if the script worked."
- Identity — "I'm a Lego master, not a follower."
- Future ignoring — gives permission to drop the playbook again next week.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

"I started following the instructions. Got a flash of confidence. Stopped crossing off. Started free-styling. The build collapsed."

WHAT IT UNLOCKS:

- Honest debrief — "Here's the step I skipped."
- Repairable next attempt — go back to the instructions.
- Trust in the system — the system isn't on trial. The discipline is.

BREAKING THE LOOP

Before reaching for "the instructions were bad," answer this first: did I follow them? If you can't point at the cross-offs, the question can't be answered — and the system isn't what failed.

The two-week test.

Settle the question once. Run the experiment with clean variables. Then read the result.

THE COMMITMENT

For two full weeks, follow the playbook to the letter. No additions. No subtractions. No creative interpretations. Whatever the coach says, do it exactly. At the end, read the result and discuss.

WHY THE TEST WORKS

01 TIME-BOXED

Two weeks. Nobody's asking for a lifetime. The window is short enough to commit to and long enough to produce signal.

02 FALSIFIABLE

If the system genuinely doesn't work, the test reveals it. The rep wins either way - either the system delivers or the rep has data to push back with.

03 REMOVES AMBIGUITY

Right now nobody knows if the system works because nobody's run it cleanly. The test eliminates the variable that's been polluting every previous attempt - the rep's improvisation.

04 PROTECTS THE RELATIONSHIP

Stops the loop of arguing in the abstract about whether the coach is right. Replaces it with an experiment both sides agreed to run.

THE CHALLENGE

Pick the window. Commit to the discipline. Read the result at the end. Stop arguing about it in the meantime.

Daily reference card.

Print and pin. Read before every pitch.

DO · EVERY PITCH

- Open the playbook before you start.
- Run step one exactly. Then step two.
- Cross off each step as you complete it.
- Stay in instruction mode if it's a pitch.
- Treat the script as the build, not a suggestion.
- Notice the third-of-the-way-in confidence flash.
- Hold the line through the flash.
- Debrief honestly — point at the cross-offs.

DON'T · EVER

- Don't free-style mid-pitch.
- Don't decide you're past the instructions.
- Don't skip the cross-off step.
- Don't blame the playbook before checking yourself.
- Don't confuse creativity time with instruction time.
- Don't argue in the abstract — run the test.
- Don't try to finish the build without the book open.
- Don't pretend you were following when you weren't.

WATCH-OUTS

- The "I'm a Lego master" moment.
- Confidence drift around step three or four.
- Quietly pushing the book aside.
- Building speed > building accuracy.
- Reaching for the easiest explanation when it fails.
- Letting the loop run for a second week.
- Mistaking discipline for being controlled.
- Treating the cross-off as paperwork.

THE ONE-LINER

Pick. Pack. Cross off. Build. Follow the instructions and the jet hopper builds itself.